

Leave the driver in the locker. Middle of the green. Look up.

Four and a half thousand yards of the same dunes. It doesn't count, so play it like it does.

HODUS 50TH · IRELAND · SEPTEMBER 2026
Royal County Down · Royal Portrush · Portstewart · Rosapenna

Quick Look

The holes that need a decision before you pull a club.

Leave the driver in the bag: everywhere but 2 and 16 Thirteen par 4s, one of them 400, the rest between 258 and 349 on 25-yard fairways. Hybrid and wedge is the day.

Hardest by index: 6, 16, 9, 12 The 6th is the pick of the course and stroke index 1: 25 yards wide, no bunkers, native grass both sides, small green with a steep falloff left.

Scoring chances: 17, 18, 4, 1 Short par 4s where an iron and a wedge is a birdie look. 17 is drivable in a helping wind; 18 is the easiest on the card.

Par 3s: 3, 7, 11, 13, 14 Between 113 and 140 yards, every one a wedge or short iron to a small tilted green. Middle, two putts, walk.

The new holes: 9, 10, 11 The 2015 loop around the big dune. Bolder ground than the rest, the best views on the property, and the 10th runs along the beach.

Photos: 9 tee, 10, 8 green From the 9th tee back across the Championship to the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne. The 10th tee by the sea. The dunes beyond the 8th green.

Greens Small, perched and sloping, with run-offs all round. Distance control is the whole examination; fly it to the middle.

HODUS 50TH · SEPTEMBER 2026

The Annesley

Royal County Down · Newcastle, Co. Down



Field Guide

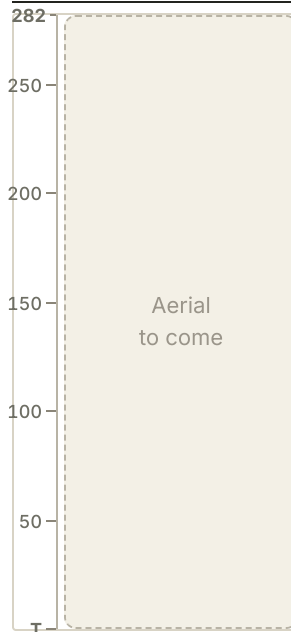
White tees · Par 67 · 4,594 yards

George Combe · Donald Steel · Mackenzie & Ebert 2015

The Amuse Bouche · Sunday 13 September · notes from the published reviews, not from Joe

1 PAR 4 · 282 YDS · SI 11

IRON / HYBRID OPENER GUIDE



TEE Iron or hybrid. At 282 there is nothing driver can do for you except find the native grass. Leave yourself a full wedge from the fairway.

LINE Center of the fairway.

IN Middle of the green, whatever the flag. The greens here are small and tilted; the middle is the only safe place.

NOTE The first of thirteen par 4s under 400 yards. Get the opening tee shot in play and the round settles down.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

Annesley Rules

The same dunes as the Championship, a third shorter and half as wide. Read once, then go and enjoy it. **Bold** means Joe said it.

1. Leave the driver in the locker. Thirteen par 4s and only one of them reaches 400. On most of them a hybrid or iron leaves a wedge; the driver leaves you in the native grass. The 2nd and the 16th are the only holes where the big club earns its place.

2. The fairways are 25 to 30 yards wide. Miss either side and it's native grass, not rough — a lost ball, not a bad lie. Position beats distance on every tee. Give yourself a buffer from whichever side is worse.

3. Small greens, sloping, with run-offs. Distance control is the whole game here. The greens are perched and tilted, and short or long rolls off. Fly it to the middle, take your two putts, walk.

4. Fewer clubs, more shots. The Fried Egg played it with four clubs and a putter and had the round of the trip. Half sets are welcome; creativity is the point. It is the warm-up, so warm up.

5. A few blind shots, not many. Far fewer than next door, but the dunes hide a green or two. Get the line from the marker or your playing partners and commit to it.

6. Stop at 9, 10 and 11. The 2015 holes circle the biggest dune on the property. The 9th tee looks back across the Championship links to the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne; the 10th runs closer to the beach than any of the 36 holes. Take the photo.

7. It doesn't count. Nothing here touches the match. Play it for the fun of it, sort out your caddie small talk, and find out how the ball is running in the dunes before it matters on Monday.

Tee Times

Sunday 13 September · 3 groups off the first tee · does not count towards the match

TIME	GROUP
1:30 PM	Dan Murray · Eric Strong · Dave Harris · Galen Archibald
1:40 PM	Jim Mitchell · Matt Burns · Jim Hughes · Lee Einhorn
1:50 PM	Matt Hodus · Todd Moutafian · Jeff Pinksa · Joe Gulash
SCORES	
NOTES	

2

PAR 4 · 400 YDS · SI 5

DRIVERLONGESTGUIDE

400

350

300

250

200

150

100

50

T

Aerial to come

TEE

The one hole where the driver comes out. 400 yards, the longest on the course by fifty and the only one past the 350 mark.

LINE

Center. Same fairway width as everywhere else, so the distance has to come with accuracy.

IN

A mid-iron to a small target. Enough club to carry to the middle; short and it feeds back off the front.

NOTE

Stroke index 5. A par here is a shot gained on the field.

The Card

White tees, club scorecard. Last column is the call off the tee; bold is Joe's.

HOLE	PAR	YDS	SI	OFF THE TEE
1	4	282	11	Iron or hybrid, center. Full wedge in.
2	4	400	5	Driver, center. The long one.
3	3	129	9	Wedge or short iron. Middle.
4	4	267	17	Iron to the flat, then a wedge.
5	4	272	7	Hybrid or iron, center.
6	4	338	1	Hybrid or 3W, center. Position, not length.
7	3	124	15	Wedge. Middle of the green.
8	4	264	13	Iron to the right-hand ledge.
9	4	294	3	Hybrid, center. Look first.
OUT	34	2370		
10	4	328	6	Hybrid or 3W from the high tee.
11	3	113	18	Wedge. Middle.
12	4	307	4	Hybrid, center.
13	3	138	8	Short iron. Middle.
14	3	140	14	Short iron. Middle.
15	4	277	10	Iron or hybrid, center.
16	4	349	2	3W or driver, center.
17	4	258	16	Iron to a wedge, or have a go.
18	4	314	12	Fairway wood or long iron, then a short one.
IN	33	2224		
TOTAL	67	4,594		

18

PAR 4 · 314 YDS · SI 12



TEE A fairway wood or long iron, then a short shot in. National Club Golfer calls it the easiest hole on the card and a birdie chance to finish.

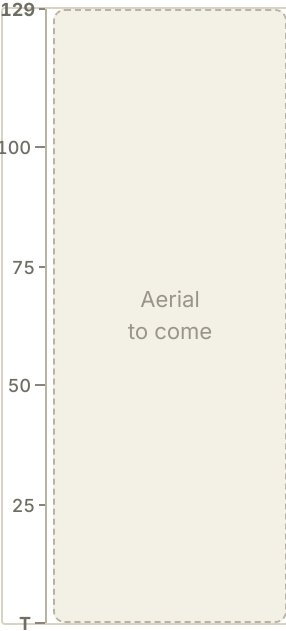
LINE Center.

IN Middle of the green.

NOTE Back to the clubhouse with the Championship 18th alongside. Same walk tomorrow, with the driver.

3

PAR 3 · 129 YDS · SI 9



CLUB 129 yards, a wedge or a short iron. The first of the five par 3s.

LINE Middle of the green.

WATCH Here the course turns in toward the big dunes. Slopes and run-offs surround a small green; anything that misses the surface keeps going.

NOTE Stroke index 9 for a 129-yard hole tells you what the green is like.

16

PAR 4 · 349 YDS · SI 2



TEE The second longest hole and stroke index 2. A 3-wood or a careful driver; this and the 2nd are the only tee shots that want length.

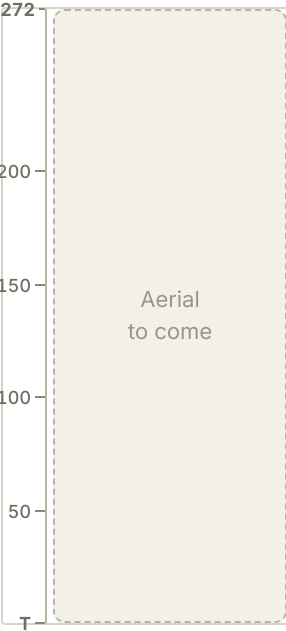
LINE Center of the fairway.

IN Mid-iron. Middle of the green, enough club to reach it.

NOTE Par here and on the 6th wins the day.

5

PAR 4 · 272 YDS · SI 7



TEE Hybrid or long iron. From here to the 15th the Annesley threads the corridors between the Championship holes 11 through 17, so you are in the same dunes as tomorrow.

LINE Center.

IN Short pitch. Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 7 on a 272-yard hole. The rating is about the green and the grass, not the length.

4

PAR 4 · 267 YDS · SI 17

POSITIONPERCHED GREENGUIDE

267

200

150

100

50

T

Aerial
to come

TEE An iron. The fairway has the most movement on the course and accuracy off the tee is what opens up the angle into the green.

LINE Ask what the fairway is doing before you pick a spot; a flat lie is worth more than ten extra yards.

IN The green is perched on a dune. Precise distance control keeps the ball on top of it; short falls away, long is gone.

NOTE Stroke index 17, but the Fried Egg singles it out for the fairway and the green. Easy on the card, not in the air.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

17

PAR 4 · 258 YDS · SI 16

DRIVABLE?SCORINGGUIDE

258

200

150

100

50

T

Aerial
to come

TEE 258 yards. Drivable for the longer hitters if the wind helps, but the fairway is no wider here than anywhere else and the miss is native grass. The sensible play is an iron and a wedge.

LINE Center.

IN Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 16 and the best scoring chance on the back nine.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

3

6

PAR 4 · 338 YDS · SI 1

HYBRIDNO BUNKERSSI 1GUIDE

338

300

250

200

150

100

50

T

Aerial
to come

TEE A narrow, short par 4 that gently doglegs around a dune ridge into which the green is nestled. The fairway is 25 yards wide and has tumultuous contours, which is why it needs no bunkers.

LINE Center of the fairway and nothing else. Miss left or right and the ball is lost in native grass, not found in rough.

IN The green is small and perfectly situated up in the dunes, with a steep falloff on the left. Middle of the green, favor the right half.

NOTE Stroke index 1 and the Fried Egg's favorite hole on the course. Par is a genuine win.

Scale in yards from the white tee

WIND _____

15

PAR 4 · 277 YDS · SI 10

IRON / HYBRIDGUIDE

277

250

200

150

100

50

T

Aerial
to come

TEE Iron or hybrid. The last of the holes threaded through the Championship corridors.

LINE Center.

IN Wedge. Middle of the green.

Scale in yards from the white tee

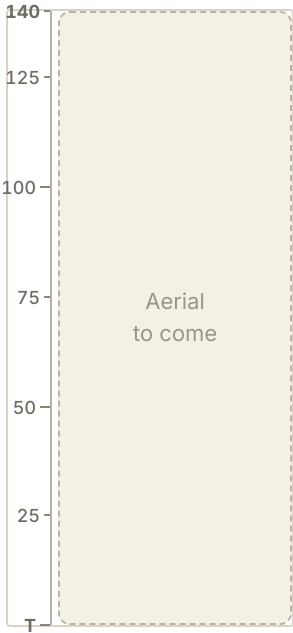
WIND _____

4

14

PAR 3 · 140 YDS · SI 14

SHORT IRON GUIDE



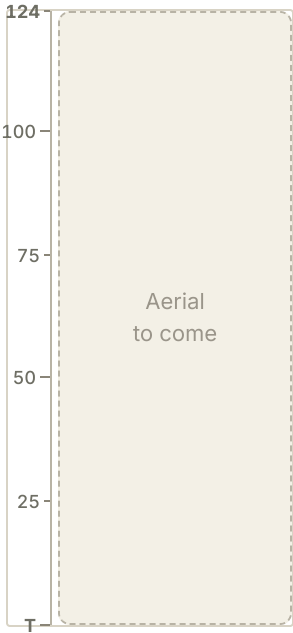
CLUB 140 yards, the second of the pair. Two short holes in a row, two different greens.
LINE Middle of the green.
NOTE Stroke index 14.

Scale in yards from the white tee WIND _____

7

PAR 3 · 124 YDS · SI 15

WEDGE GUIDE



CLUB 124 yards, a wedge. The second shortest hole on the card.
LINE Middle of the green.
WATCH A short hole with a small green is a par or a bogey and rarely anything else. Take the middle and the two putts.
NOTE Stroke index 15.

Scale in yards from the white tee WIND _____

12

PAR 4 · 307 YDS · SI 4

HYBRID GUIDE



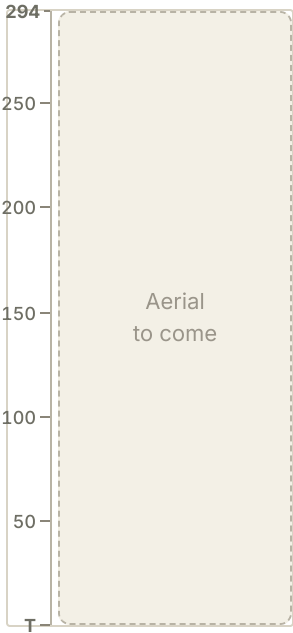
TEE Hybrid. Back into the corridors between the Championship holes.
LINE Center. Stroke index 4, so the fairway is doing something; give yourself a buffer.
IN Middle of the green, enough club to carry the front.

Scale in yards from the white tee WIND _____

9

PAR 4 · 294 YDS · SI 3

NEW 2015 PHOTO SI 3 GUIDE



TEE The first of the three Mackenzie & Ebert holes routed around the largest dune on the property. Stand on the tee before you hit: from height it looks back across the Championship links to Newcastle, the Slieve Donard spires and the Mourne behind.
LINE Center. The new holes are bolder than the old ones, with more shaped ground; trust the middle.
IN Middle of the green.
NOTE Stroke index 3.

Scale in yards from the white tee WIND _____

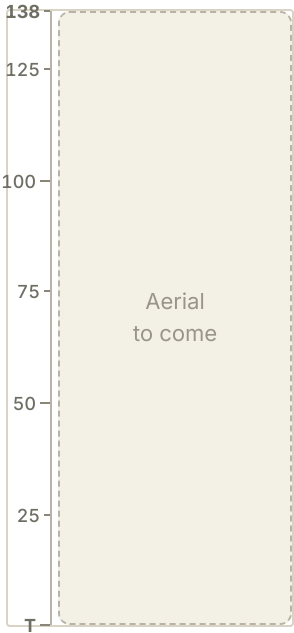


TEE The hole plays along a ridgeline that falls off on either side of the fairway. An iron that stays on top is everything.

LINE There is a pronounced ledge on the right side of the fairway that gives the best angle into the green. Aim for it.

IN Short pitch from the ledge. Middle of the green.

NOTE The view beyond the 8th green is one of the best on the course, dunes to the horizon.



CLUB 138 yards. The first of back-to-back par 3s.

LINE Middle of the green.

NOTE Stroke index 8 on a 138-yard hole. Respect the green.

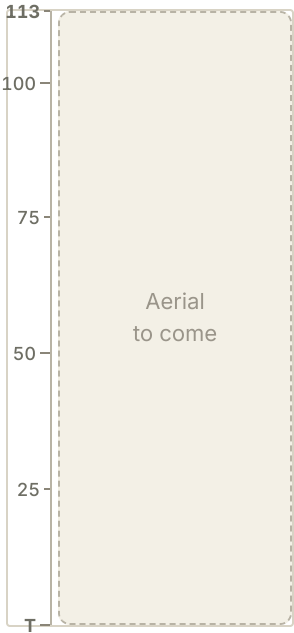


TEE An elevated tee shot on the hole that runs closer to the beach than any of the 36 at Royal County Down. Wind off the sea is the whole calculation.

LINE Center. Let the elevation do the work; take less club than the number.

IN Middle of the green.

NOTE The second of the 2015 holes and the one everyone photographs.



CLUB 113 yards, the shortest hole on the course and the last of the three new ones, tucked against the big dune.

LINE Middle of the green.

WATCH Stroke index 18. Short and easy on paper; the dune and the wind decide what club it really is.